

Recreating an ETF, share by share.

We buy and manage the Nasdaq-100's individual shares ourselves, then compare Irish taxes with owning an ETF.

Provisional estimates. Substantial weight drift and execution limits affect interpretation. See the assessment on pages 5–8.

HIGHEST SELECTED RESULT

€998,425

**Sell losses weekly;
sell and rebuy current stocks
in December**

+€247,696

versus the ETF

+€45,806

versus the stock baseline

After liquidation, taxes and costs.

Hold the ETF

Fund tax on gains, including eight-year deemed disposal.

€750,729

Buy underlying company shares directly; keep stocks that leave

No voluntary sales before the final sale of everything.

€952,619

Sell losing shares each month

Sell eligible losses; no December sales to use the exemption.

€988,601

Sell losses monthly; sell former index stocks first in December

Then sell and rebuy eligible current stocks to use remaining exemption.

€994,222

Sell losses weekly; sell and rebuy current stocks in December

Sell at a covered profit; rebuy to reset the purchase cost for future CGT.

€998,425

€0

FINAL WEALTH · LINEAR SCALE

€1m

All three active stock strategies: review former index stocks quarterly; sell only when the sale adds no CGT.

December profit sales use existing losses first, then the remaining €1,270 exemption. Eligibility limits apply.

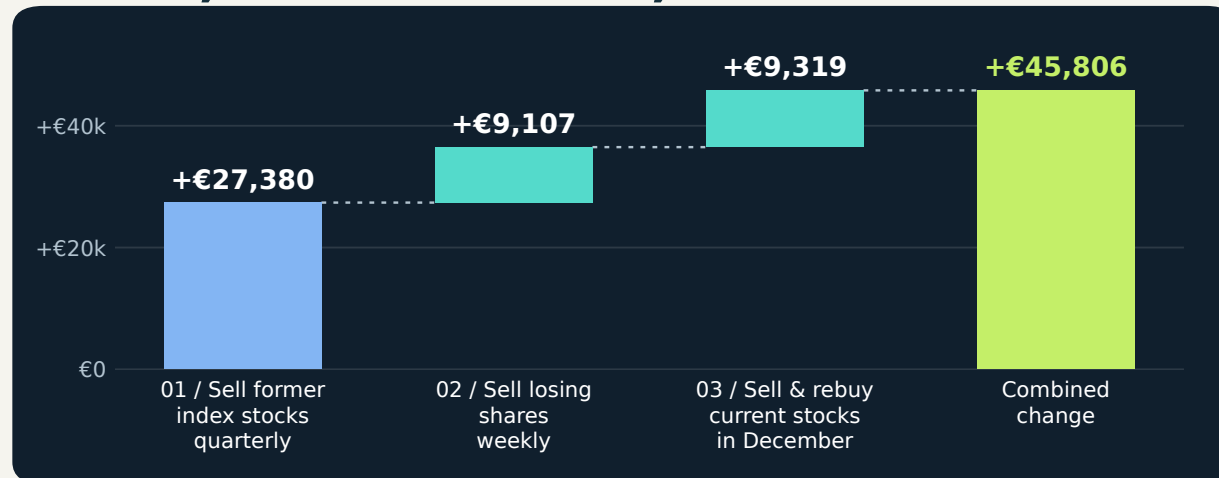
€210,936.48 invested / 192 payments / 16 years. Nominal wealth; differences include holdings, costs and tax.

Where the gains came from.

Change one rule at a time; compare complete portfolios after all taxes and costs.

THE WEEKLY STRATEGY, BUILT IN THREE STEPS

€952,619 → €998,425



ALTERNATIVE: CHECK LOSSES MONTHLY

+€8,602: sell losses monthly. Then +€5,621:

sell former index stocks first in December; then sell & rebuy current stocks.

THE ANNUAL EXEMPTION: OFF → ON

Weekly loss sales; December sell & rebuy

+€13,243

change in final wealth

Nominal exemption relief: €6,368

Monthly loss sales; former stocks first

-€700

change in final wealth

Nominal exemption relief: €6,787

The three steps add because each builds on the previous rule. The exemption cards are separate experiments.

Wealth effects include holdings, costs and reinvestment. Nominal relief is exempt gains × 33%.

Loss and gain harvesting interact: effects measured against different controls cannot simply be added.

How we manage our own index portfolio.

Leading strategy: contributions, net dividends and sale proceeds top up eligible index stocks below their target weights.

01 / EVERY FRIDAY

Sell losing shares

Sell a whole holding at $\geq 5\%$ and $\geq \text{€}25$ loss.
No buy of that share class in prior 29 days;
block repurchase for 29 days afterwards.
Reinvest in other current index stocks.

02 / EACH QUARTER

Sell former index stocks

Sell when existing losses and remaining
exemption cover the gain without extra
CGT. Keep other departed holdings.

03 / EACH DECEMBER

Sell and rebuy at a profit

Sell eligible current stocks; buy them back.
Use existing losses, then the remaining
 $\text{€}1,270$ exemption, to cover gains. Oldest
shares sell first; no losing lots; fees apply.

Monthly alternative: sell losses monthly. In December, sell former index stocks first; then sell and rebuy current stocks.

Three rules that fell behind.

PREVIOUSLY WEAK RULES, REPLAYED

SHORTFALL VS CONTROL

WHAT CHANGED

Sell even tiny losses (from $\text{€}1$)

—**€22,369**

1,403 loss sales vs 424;
fees and holdings changed.

Keep stocks that leave the index

—**€26,624**

Kept former constituents;
lower tax, lower final wealth.

Sell and rebuy profitable shares monthly

—**€37,500**

720 gain sales vs 198;
the annual allowance stayed fixed.

Controls: sell former stocks quarterly; sell/rebuy current stocks each December. Monthly loss sales for rows 1/3; none for row 2.

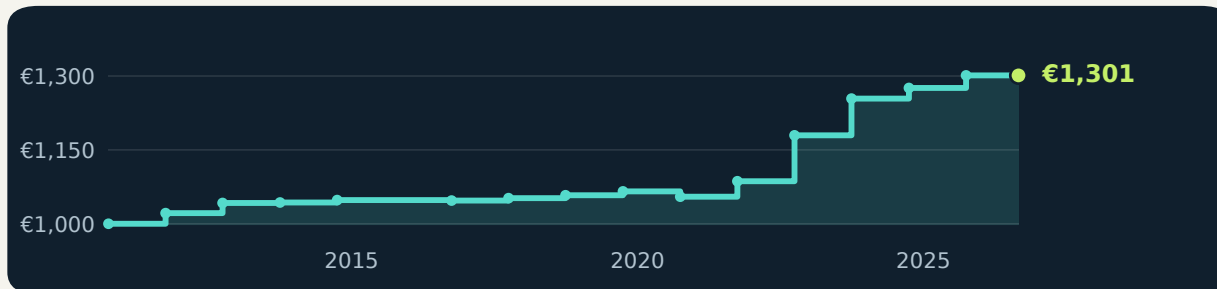
What the comparison assumes.

Same scheduled funding. Frozen tax scenarios. A provisional historical reconstruction.

CONTRIBUTIONS FOLLOW IRISH CPI

€1,000.00 → €1,301.28

Per month / €210,936.48 contributed over 16 years



Each September: €1,000 × August CPI ÷ August 2010 CPI.

Published data only; increases and decreases apply.
Same scheduled flows; three stock deposits post next session.
CSO CPI: December 2006=100; current, non-revised series.

THE TAX SCENARIO

33%

STOCK CAPITAL GAINS

€1,270

ANNUAL CGT EXEMPTION

52.35%

DIVIDEND TAX

38% / 8y

FUND TAX / DEEMED DISPOSAL

No unrelated gains consume the allowance.

READ THE RESULTS AS A BACKTEST

Strategies were selected retrospectively, not out of sample.
Weights, membership and corporate actions remain provisional;
some holdings use nontradable marks. Wealth is nominal.

Research only. Not tax, legal or investment advice.

Methodology, ledgers, source links and legal notice: README + study_manifest.json

COSTS & INTERPRETATION

0.15% FX each non-euro trade; no extra spread or slippage.
ETF NAV includes fund costs. Tax rates are frozen scenarios,
not each year's legislation. See the assessment on pages 5–8.

What the results can support.

Accuracy assessment / 4 October 2026 / Numerical consistency does not establish real-world accuracy.

REPRODUCIBLE SCENARIO / LIMITED EVIDENCE OF REAL-WORLD PERFORMANCE

The balances follow the checked model and cached inputs. The stock portfolio differs substantially from its targets.
The study does not establish an executable, tax-compliant replica or a reliable forecast.
There is no defensible overall accuracy percentage or measured error interval for final wealth.

THE ETF GAP IS NOT A PURE TAX BENEFIT

ETF → direct-share baseline	+€201,890
Then: quarterly departure sales	+€27,380
Then: weekly loss sales	+€9,107
Then: December gain sales	+€9,319

Total difference from the ETF **+€247,696**

These sequential policy effects include different securities, taxes, fees, and reinvestment. They depend on this path.
Most of the gap exists before the extra sale rules.

TOP TEN SHARE CLASSES

70.00%

Held stock value / 29 Sep 2026

46.38%

Last known targets / 31 Aug 2026

Targets assumed available on 7 September.
Different dates: this is target-weight drift, not contemporaneous ETF tracking error.
Large weights in winners change risk and return.

The weekly strategy leads the monthly hybrid by only €4,203 (0.42%).

One retrospectively selected market path does not prove an optimal strategy, equal risk, or future superiority.

Where realism is limited.

Some limits have a measured scale. The combined effect on final wealth and strategy rank remains unknown.

01 / HISTORICAL WEIGHTS

Stale inputs; assumed release dates

Mean source age: 48.1 days. Maximum: 213 days.
29/192 deposit dates use weights over 90 days old.
Fund snapshots stay fixed between updates.
Prior-date checks do not prove assumed release dates.

02 / PORTFOLIO EXECUTION

Decisions and trades use the same close

The model observes closing prices, then trades at them.
It has no next-session execution validation.
Ordinary dividends use ex-date cash accrual.
ETF NAV and ECB FX are valuation references.

03 / INCOMPLETE CASH FLOWS

Known omissions have a small direct scale

Weekly peak proxy marks / total portfolio: 0.1231%.
Five verified missing dividends total under €2 gross
per stock case, at payment-date FX. The full total is unknown.
Neither measure bounds valuation or portfolio errors.

04 / TAX CLASSIFICATION

Core formulas have conditional support

Loss ordering, exemption and fund credits agree with
Revenue guidance under the stated assumptions.
84 corporate-action classifications remain provisional.
The weekly case encounters 33 of those actions.

05 / PERSONAL TAX AND DATES

Frozen tax rates; approximate payment dates

Rates do not reconstruct each year's legislation.
Dividend tax and treaty credits depend on the investor.
The €1,270 exemption is shared with other eligible gains.
Tax reserves and settlement dates affect investable cash.

06 / BROKER FEASIBILITY

Thousands of small fractional purchases

Weekly case: 16,739 buys, median outlay €10.55.
15,119 purchases buy less than one share.
Historical instrument access is not reconstructed.
Spreads, some charges and investor time are absent.

How assumptions change the result.

Complete cost replays and ETF controls. Diagnostic scenarios, not calibrated costs or confidence intervals.

STOCK CASES / FINAL AFTER-TAX WEALTH

Strategy	Published costs	+5 bp per side	+25 bp per side
Retained-share baseline	€952,619	€951,682	€947,947
Monthly loss sales	€988,601	€986,899	€979,971
Monthly hybrid	€994,222	€993,187	€978,787
Weekly loss + annual gain sales	€998,425	€996,425	€983,080

The two monthly strategies reverse order at 25 bp. Weekly remains highest among these four cases.
1 bp = 0.01%. FX stays at 0.15%. The extra cost also affects certain corporate cash receipts.

ETF CONTROLS / SAME NAV AND CONTRIBUTIONS

41% before 2026, then 38% / rate-only change	€736,577	−€14,152
38% with no interim deemed disposal / hypothetical	€870,578	+€119,849

No deemed disposal still includes final fund tax. It is not an available tax election.

ETF cash management: pay a same-day tax bill from the contribution before any unit sale.

Independent control: €754,335 final wealth, or +€3,606. Contribution dates and totals stay the same.

All controls retain other model limits. They do not establish an error range or resolve exposure and execution differences.

What we checked. What remains open.

Evidence supports arithmetic and specific model comparisons. It does not certify every input or legal interpretation.

VERIFICATION COMPLETED

Full replay: 14 stock cases and the ETF.
90 CSV/JSON outputs match exactly after parsing.
122 existing unit and synthetic checks passed.
21 recorded input/code hashes match.
Independent ledger checks: all 14 stock cases pass.
Maximum cash residual is below €0.000001.
Independent ETF lot arithmetic reproduces the baseline.

LIMITS OF THAT VERIFICATION

A replay uses the same engine and cached inputs.
Ledger checks detect arithmetic and consistency errors.
They do not prove price accuracy or source completeness.
Cost stresses keep same-close execution and selected history.
Shared sources can contain shared errors.
No independent holdout or probability of future success exists.

NEXT EVIDENCE NEEDED

Executable decisions with a later trade price.
A comparison with matched investment exposures.
Complete dividends and event-specific Irish tax treatment.
A joint historical-rate and payment-date replay.
Independent periods with rules fixed before evaluation.

PRIMARY SOURCES / CLICK TO OPEN

[Revenue / CGT and annual exemption](#)
[Revenue / share identification and four-week rules](#)
[Revenue / 2026 fund-tax rate](#)
[Revenue / fund tax and deemed-disposal credits](#)
[iShares / fund NAV and expenses](#)
[ECB / reference FX rates](#)

Full assessment, reproducible evidence, broker and issuer sources

[docs/ACCURACY_ASSESSMENT.md](#) · [historical/checks/accuracy*](#) · [results/latest/accuracy*](#)

This is a documented software and research assessment. It is not an external financial audit or a Revenue ruling.